



SKY HIGH

Financial Management

Personal Tax Preparation Checklist

Introduction

Preparing your personal tax return is easier when your documents are organized and your income, deductions, and credits are properly tracked.

This checklist helps Canadian taxpayers gather the information needed to prepare an accurate tax return and avoid missing valuable deductions and benefits.

1. Personal Information

- ☐ Confirm your personal information:
 - Full legal name
 - Address
 - Date of birth
 - Social Insurance Number (SIN)
 - Marital status
 - Information about spouse or common-law partner
- ☐ Update CRA records if your personal information has changed.

2. Employment Income Documents

- ☐ Collect employment-related documents:
 - T4 Employment Income Slips
 - T4A slips (if applicable)
 - Employment expense documents (if eligible)
- ☐ Review:
 - Employment income
 - Tax deducted
 - CPP contributions
 - EI premiums
- ☐ Confirm all employment slips are received before filing.

3. Investment Income

- ☐ Collect investment-related documents:
 - T3 slips
 - T5 slips
 - T5008 statements
 - Investment statements
- ☐ Review:
 - Interest income
 - Dividend income
 - Capital gains or losses
 - Foreign investment income
- ☐ Keep investment purchase and sale records.

4. Self-Employment Income

(For freelancers, contractors, and sole proprietors)

- ☐ Gather business income records:
 - Sales invoices
 - Customer payments
 - Contracts
 - Business income summaries
- ☐ Organize business expenses:
 - Advertising
 - Office supplies
 - Software subscriptions
 - Vehicle expenses
 - Professional fees
 - Insurance
 - Rent
 - Home office expenses (if applicable)
- ☐ Maintain supporting receipts and documentation.

5. RRSP Contributions

- ☐ Collect RRSP contribution receipts
- ☐ Review:
 - RRSP contribution amount
 - Available contribution room
 - Previous unused contributions
- ☐ Consider whether RRSP contributions should be used to reduce taxable income.

6. TFSA Review

- ☐ Review TFSA activity:
 - Contributions
 - Withdrawals
 - Available contribution room
- ☐ Confirm investment income earned inside a TFSA is properly treated.

7. Rental Income (If Applicable)

- ☐ Gather rental income information:
 - Rental agreements
 - Rent received
 - Tenant records
- ☐ Collect rental expense documents:
 - Mortgage interest
 - Property taxes
 - Insurance
 - Repairs and maintenance
 - Utilities
 - Management fees
- ☐ Separate personal and rental expenses.

8. Medical Expenses

- ☐ Collect eligible medical expense receipts:
 - Prescription expenses
 - Dental expenses
 - Vision expenses
 - Medical services
 - Health insurance premiums (where applicable)
- ☐ Confirm the eligible claim period.

9. Childcare and Family Expenses

- ☐ Gather childcare documents:
 - Childcare receipts
 - Provider information
- ☐ Review eligibility for:
 - Childcare expense deductions
 - Canada Child Benefit information
 - Other family-related credits

10. Education Expenses

- ☐ Collect:
 - T2202 Tuition Certificate
 - Student loan interest documents
 - Education-related receipts
- ☐ Review available education-related tax credits.

11. Charitable Donations

- ☐ Collect official donation receipts
- ☐ Review:
 - Eligible charities
 - Donation amounts
 - Carry-forward donations from previous years

12. Home and Property Information

- ☐ Gather documents related to:
 - Home purchase or sale
 - Principal residence information
 - Rental properties
 - Home renovations (if applicable)
- ☐ Review the tax implications before selling property.

13. Foreign Income and Assets

- ☐ Review whether you have:
 - Foreign employment income
 - Foreign investment income
 - Foreign rental income
 - Foreign bank accounts
 - Foreign investments
- ☐ Determine whether additional reporting is required:
 - Foreign income reporting
 - Form T1135 (if applicable)

14. CRA My Account Review

- ☐ Access CRA My Account
- ☐ Review:
 - Previous Notice of Assessment
 - RRSP contribution room
 - TFSA contribution room
 - Available credits
 - Unused balances
- ☐ Confirm CRA has your correct contact information.

15. Before Filing Your Tax Return

- ☐ Verify all income sources are included
- ☐ Review available deductions and credits
- ☐ Confirm banking information for direct deposit
- ☐ Keep a copy of your filed tax return
- ☐ Save supporting documents for future reference

16. Common Mistakes to Avoid

- ☐ Waiting until tax season to organize documents
- ☐ Missing investment income slips
- ☐ Forgetting RRSP contribution receipts
- ☐ Not reporting foreign income
- ☐ Claiming expenses without proper documentation
- ☐ Ignoring CRA notices and deadlines

17. Documents to Keep in Your Tax Folder

- Income slips
- Receipts
- Investment statements
- RRSP/TFSA documents
- Medical receipts
- Donation receipts
- Rental documents
- Prior tax returns
- Other documents if any

Final Reminder

A well-prepared tax return is not only about filing on time. Proper organization throughout the year helps you maximize available deductions, reduce errors, and make better financial decisions.



Sky High Financial Management

Personal Tax Preparation • Tax Planning • Accounting Support • CRA Compliance

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